v158TH FIGHTER WING
HOME OF THE GREEN MOUNTAIN BOYS
THE GREEN MOUNTAIN BOYS
HQ VERMONT AIR NATIONAL GUARD

STRIKE!

High-Aspect Basic Fighter Maneuvers

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vCOL Marceline “Smore” J.
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Basic Fighter Maneuvering (BFM)

Basic Tenets of ACM

Outlined here are the common tenets of BFM which represent the fundamentals of air combat.

- **Lose Sight, Lose the Fight**
  - You must gain and maintain a visual with the bandit throughout the engagement.

- **Maneuver in Relation to the Bandit**
  - Observe, predict, and maneuver. Fly the aircraft to take advantage of errors committed by the bandit.

- **Nose Position vs. Energy**
  - Assess your options whether to sacrifice energy advantage for WEZ advantage, and vice versa.

- **Lead vs. Pure vs. Lag Pursuit**

High Aspect BFM (HABFM)

HABFM

High Aspect Basic Fighter Maneuvering (HABFM) can occur during close-range phases of any tactical engagement. While ideally prevented through a lead turn, or denied through BVR tactics altogether, it's critical to know which moves to play. Remember, in a neutral fight, any turning room for you is turning room for the adversary. There are four primary concepts to understand during neutral/HABFM:

- Merge: Both aircraft cross each other's 3/9 line, wherein, given no lead turn has been performed, the fight is neutral, and the aircraft are tail-to-tail.
- Lead Turns: Either aircraft turns early to enter a lower aspect on the other aircraft prior to a merge.
- One Circle: Occurs when both aircraft turn in the same direction post-merge, inscribing a flight path of a single circle over the ground. Preferred in jets with a smaller turning radius than the adversary.
- Two Circle: Occurs when both aircraft turn in opposite directions post-merge, inscribing a flight path of a single circle over the ground. Preferred in jets with a higher sustained turn performance.

Additional Study Materials

HABFM by Cider C
Introduction to High Aspect BFM by Mike Solyom

End

You have completed the lesson portion covering BFM.